QUR'AN VOCABULARY

رَبّ · أَرْض · قَوْم · آيَة · كُلّ

The 25 Most Common Nouns in the Qur'an

Learn these and you will recognise thousands of words

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If you learn just these 25 nouns, you will recognise thousands of words across the Qur'an. Here they are, from most to least common, with how many times each appears.

1. **Lord, Sustainer:** 975 ,رَبّ times
2. **earth:** 461 ,أَرْض times
3. **people, a nation:** 383 ,قَوْم times
4. **a sign, a verse:** 382 ,آيَة times
5. **every, all:** 358 ,كُلّ times
6. **messenger:** 332 ,رَسُول times
7. **day:** 325 ,يَوْم times
8. **punishment:** 322 ,عَذَاب times
9. **sky, heaven:** 310 ,سَمَاء times
10. **soul, self:** 295 ,نَفْس times
11. **a thing:** 283 ,شَيْء times
12. **a book:** 260 ,كِتَاب times

13. **truth:** 242 ,حَقّ times
14. **people, mankind:** 241 ,نَاس times
15. **before:** 197 ,قَبْل times
16. **believer:** 195 ,مُؤْمِن times
17. **path, way:** 176 ,سَبِيل times
18. **command, matter:** 166 ,أَمْر times
19. **some:** 157 ,بَعْض times
20. **O (calling):** 153 ,أَيُّهَا times
21. **good, better:** 148 ,خَيْر times
22. **god, deity:** 147 ,إِلَٰه times
23. **fire:** 145 ,نَار times
24. **other than, not:** 144 ,غَيْر times
25. **besides, other than:** 135 ,دُون times

Three things to notice

The top word is رَبّ "Lord". Nearly a thousand times, the Qur'an names Allah as the one who creates, raises and looks after. You met it in Al-Fatihah: رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ "Lord of all the worlds".

Two words for "people". قَوْم is a particular nation, as in قَوْمِ نُوحٍ "the people of Noah"; نَاس is people in general, the last word of the Qur'an (114:6).

Some "nouns" work like prepositions. قَبْل "before", بَعْض "some", غَيْر "other than" and دُون "besides" are nouns in Arabic grammar, but in English we translate them as small linking words. You will see them almost on every page.

Try this: open any page of the Qur'an and count how many of these 25 you can find.

From my book Quran Grammar Summary *(second edition), section 6.1, which lists the top 300 nouns, the top 300 verbs and every particle in the Qur'an.*

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